

MELISSA DESMARAIS

Strategic Pricing & Commercial Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven pricing and commercial executive with a proven record of delivering transformative growth and market leadership for Fortune 500 enterprises. Expert in architecting data-driven commercial strategies that integrate advanced analytics (**Python, SQL, Power BI**) with operational excellence to generate over **\$100M in margin expansion**. A visionary cross-functional leader specializing in building and scaling high-performance teams, optimizing complex pricing ecosystems, and operationalizing strategies to achieve dominant market positioning and exceed financial targets.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategic Leadership

- P&L Optimization & Profitability Management
- Commercial Strategy & Competitive Pricing Analysis
- Cross-Functional Leadership
- Senior Stakeholder Influence
- Vendor Management & Negotiation
- High-Performance Culture Building
- Transformational Leadership
- Pricing Strategy & Execution

Technical Expertise

- Python (Pandas, NumPy)
- SQL (PostgreSQL)
- Alteryx (ETL/Data Blending)
- Advanced Excel (VBA)
- Data Pipeline Architecture
- Tableau/Power BI
- Statistical Modeling
- Pricing Data Analysis

Business Operations

- Revenue Growth Management (RGM)
- Trade Promotion Management (TPM)
- Financial Forecasting
- Market Performance Analysis
- Process Optimization
- Operational Readiness
- Syndicated Data Analysis (Nielsen/IRI)
- KPI Governance
- Performance Reporting

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

BJ's Wholesale Club Inc | Marlborough, MA

Lead Pricing Analyst | June 2024 – Present

- Architected pricing strategies for 12+ categories, delivering \$10.3M (25%) of team's \$41.5M FY24 margin growth; identified new pricing opportunities supporting General Merchandise transformation.
- Led enterprise pricing platform rollout and competitive intelligence transformation, managing 7 analysts to achieve 95% match accuracy across 174K+ recommendations and optimize data pipelines (30% faster reporting).
- Directed strategic vendor integration: Managed RFP process and initial onboarding achieving 99% SLA compliance; navigated vendor instability through cross-functional collaboration and contingency planning.
- Executed 6 full category reviews in H1 FY2026, increasing match coverage 25%+ and strengthening foundation for category-specific pricing strategies.
- Blueprinted Pricing Data Maintenance role and completed hiring (June 2026); currently designing Pricing Execution roles in partnership with Genpact.
- Owned end-to-end blueprint documentation and risk assessment for Pricing Team roles, ensuring scalability amid organizational knowledge gaps. Partnered with merchants across LOBs to refine match criteria, increasing accuracy 15%+ and enabling confident pricing decisions.
- Strengthened merchant collaboration across business lines, optimizing match logic to raise pricing data accuracy by 15% and support confident margin-positive decision-making.

Senior Pricing Analyst | Nov 2020 – May 2024

- Generated \$37.2M margin lift and 6% FY24 revenue growth via pricing/promotion optimization
- Engineered process framework saving 468 annual hours through automated reporting (Excel VBA/SQL)
- Piloted GM strategy toolkit reducing category launch timelines by 40% with 15% cost optimization

HMS HOST INTERNATIONAL | Bethesda, MD

Senior Manager, Revenue Optimization | Jan 2016 – Oct 2020

- Drove \$35M+ annual revenue growth through strategic pricing models for foodservice operations (\$700M+ branch sales)
- Optimized profitability for 12+ high-volume branches via localized marketing and trade fund reallocation
- Led pricing strategy for 5+ QSR brands (Popeye's, Burger King, Tim Hortons), improving margin by 8-12% per brand

Senior Manager, Supply Chain | Sep 2013 – Jan 2016

- Developed supply chain reporting system that reduced cost analysis turnaround by 50% (\$2.8M annual savings)
- Directed transition to Foodbuy procurement system, maintaining 100% operational continuity for 200+ locations
- Created inventory tracking tools that reduced stockouts by 30% while decreasing carrying costs

EARLIER CAREER

ERP Analyst | HMS HOST INTERNATIONAL | Bethesda, MD

- Automated financial reconciliations between PeopleSoft/Sales Audit (1,704 annual labor hours saved)
- Streamlined AR/billing data uploads, saving 1,200+ labor hours/year through Excel-to-PeopleSoft automation

Revenue Accounting Analyst | HMS HOST INTERNATIONAL | Bethesda, MD

- Modernized revenue accounting for \$2.6B operations, resolving 99% of escalated disputes
- Led team of 5 to standardize accounting practices across 2,000+ locations, improving month-end close by 40%
- Ensured 100% credit card connectivity compliance through POS system optimizations

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Business Management & Accounting | Castleton University | Castleton, VT

Applied core accounting principles (financial, cost, tax) to develop expertise in:

- Financial analysis for strategic decision-making
- Business operations optimization
- Regulatory compliance frameworks